

음식 맛 말하기: 짜요, 싱거워요, 느끼해요

Learn ten everyday Korean taste words and use them to say how a dish tastes.

WHAT THIS IS FOR



Use 10 taste words in the polite -아요/어요 form (including ㅂ-irregular 싱거워요, 매워요), answer '맛이 어때요?' in one short sentence, and tell 싱거워요 (a complaint) apart from 담백해요 (a compliment).

1 WORDS

WORD	MEANING	IN USE
달다 → 달아요 <i>dalda → darayo</i>	sweet	이 떡은 별로 안 달아요. This rice cake isn't very sweet.
짜다 → 짜요 <i>jjada → jjayo</i>	salty	국이 좀 짜요. 물 좀 주세요. The soup is a bit salty. Could I have some water?
싱겁다 → 싱거워요 <i>singgeopda → singgeowoyo</i>	bland, not salty enough (a complaint; ㅂ-irregular: ㅂ → 워요)	찌개가 좀 싱거워요. 소금 있어요? The stew is a bit bland. Do you have salt?
맵다 → 매워요 <i>maepda → maewoyo</i>	spicy (hot), like chili pepper (ㅂ-irregular: ㅂ → 워요)	이 떡볶이는 생각보다 매워요. This tteokbokki is spicier than I thought.
시다 → 셔요 <i>sida → syeoyo</i>	sour, tart	이 귤은 아직 셔요. This tangerine is still sour.
쓰다 → 써요 <i>sseuda → sseoyo</i>	bitter (taste)	설탕을 안 넣어서 커피가 써요. The coffee is bitter because I didn't add sugar.
고소하다 → 고소해요 <i>gosohada → gosohaeyo</i>	nutty, toasty (the good taste of sesame oil, sesame seeds, or roasted nuts)	참기름을 넣어서 고소해요. It tastes nutty because I added sesame oil.
느끼하다 → 느끼해요 <i>neukkihada → neukkihaeyo</i>	greasy, too oily or rich (a complaint)	피자가 좀 느끼해요. 피클 있어요? The pizza is a bit greasy. Do you have pickles?
담백하다 → 담백해요 <i>dambaekada → dambaekaeyo</i>	light and clean-tasting, not oily or heavy (a compliment)	이 생선구이는 기름기가 적어서 담백해요. This grilled fish isn't oily, so it tastes light and clean.
얼큰하다 → 얼큰해요 <i>eolkeunhada → eolkeunhaeyo</i>	spicy and hot in a satisfying way (mostly for soups and broths)	국물이 얼큰해서 좋아요. I like it because the broth is nice and spicy.



2 YOUR TURN



USE THE TASTE WORDS

Read each item, then write or choose the taste word that fits the food or the situation.

1

Fill in the blank with the polite -아요/어요 form of the word in brackets:

- ① 간장(soy sauce)을 조금만 넣어서 나물(seasoned vegetable side dish)이 좀 _____. (싱겁다)
- ② 이 수박(watermelon)은 정말 _____. (달다)
- ③ 레몬차(lemon tea)가 좀 _____. (시다)

2

Put the words in the right order to make a sentence: 김치가 / 너무 / 매워요 / 이

3

Choose the best word for each food from this list — 써요, 고소해요, 느끼해요:

- ① 한약(Korean herbal medicine)
- ② 볶은 땅콩(roasted peanuts)
- ③ 치즈를 많이 올린 감자튀김(French fries with lots of cheese on top)

4

Your friend asks '맛이 어때요?'. Answer in one short Korean sentence:

- ① 짬뽕(spicy seafood noodle soup) — the soup is spicy and hot in a good, satisfying way.
- ② 감자칩(potato chips) — there is too much salt.

5

Is the speaker complaining or praising the food? Write 'complaint' or 'praise':

- ① 이 두부조림(braised tofu)은 좀 싱거워요.
- ② 이 백숙(boiled whole-chicken soup)은 담백해요.
- ③ 이 크림 파스타(cream pasta)는 너무 느끼해요.

ANSWERS

1) ① 싱거워요 ② 달아요 ③ 써요 (시어요 is also correct)

2) 이 김치가 너무 매워요.

3) ① 써요 ② 고소해요 ③ 느끼해요

4) ① (짬뽕이) 얼큰해요. (국물이 얼큰해요.) ② (감자칩이) 너무 짜요. (좀 짜요.)

5) ① complaint ② praise ③ complaint

